Email Challenge Button - Data Extraction Debug Guide

Issue

The “Email This Challenge” button shows “Failed to send email. Please try again.”

Root Cause Analysis

The email button script (`/public/email-challenge.js`) extracts challenge data from the page, but there are several potential points of failure:

1. Data Extraction Issues

The script tries to extract challenge data from:
- Chatbot iframe content (usually blocked by CORS)
- Visible page text as fallback

Potential problems:
- Challenge text not found or misidentified
- Required fields missing (challengeText is required)
- Data format doesn’t match API expectations

2. API Validation

The API endpoint (`/api/challenges/email`) requires:
- `challengeText` (required)
- `userEmail` (required)

If either is missing or empty, the API returns 400 Bad Request.

3. SendGrid Issues

Even if data extraction works, email sending might fail if:
- SendGrid API key invalid/expired
- Sender email not verified
- Rate limits exceeded

Debugging Steps

Step 1: Check Browser Console

1. Open chat page: https://myfoto.topues.com/chat
2. Open DevTools (F12)
3. Go to Console tab
4. Look for logs starting with `[Foto Email]`

Expected logs on page load:

```
[Foto Email] Script loaded - Version: 2024112404
[Foto Email] Target email: seun_salami@outlook.com
```

When challenge appears:

```
[Foto Email] Challenge detected in page
[Foto Email] Extracted challenge data: {
  challengeText: "...",
  category: "...",
  difficulty: "...",
  ...
}
```

If you see:
- `⚠️ Could not extract challenge title` → Data extraction failed
- `No chatbot iframe found` → Normal (iframe not accessible due to CORS)
- `Cannot access iframe content (CORS)` → Normal (using fallback method)

Step 2: Click Email Button & Check Logs

When clicking the button, look for:

```
[Foto Email] Sending challenge data: { challengeText: "...", ... }
```

Success case:

```
[Foto Email] ✅ Challenge emailed successfully
```

Failure case:

```
[Foto Email] ❌ Error: <error message>
```

Step 3: Check Network Tab

1. Open DevTools → Network tab
2. Filter by: `challenges/email`
3. Click the email button
4. Find the POST request to `/api/challenges/email`

Check:
- **Request payload**: Does it have `challengeText` and `userEmail`?
- **Response status**:
- 200 = Success
- 400 = Bad request (missing/invalid data)
- 500 = Server error
- **Response body**: What error message is returned?

Step 4: Test API Directly

You can test the email API directly using curl:

```
curl -X POST https://myfoto.topues.com/api/challenges/email \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{
    "challengeText": "Test Challenge",
    "category": "STREET",
    "difficulty": "BEGINNER",
    "duration": "30 minutes",
    "location": "Melbourne CBD",
    "recommendedGear": "Any camera",
    "tips": "Test tips",
    "weatherConditions": "Clear",
    "detailedDescription": "Test description",
    "userEmail": "seun_salami@outlook.com"
  }'
```

Expected response:

```
{
  "success": true,
  "message": "Challenge emailed to seun_salami@outlook.com"
}
```

Common Issues & Solutions

Issue 1: “Challenge text and email are required”

Cause: The script couldn’t extract `challengeText` from the page

Solution:
1. Check console for extraction logs
2. Verify challenge is actually displayed on the page
3. Try asking chatbot for a new challenge with clear structure

Ask chatbot:

```
Give me a photography challenge for Melbourne with all details including:
- Challenge title
- Category
- Difficulty
- Duration
- Location
- Recommended gear
- Tips
- Weather conditions
```

Issue 2: Email sending fails even with valid data

Cause: SendGrid configuration issue

Solution:
1. Test the SendGrid endpoint directly: https://myfoto.topues.com/api/email-test
2. Check SendGrid dashboard for any account issues
3. Verify sender email (seun@topues.com) is still verified

Issue 3: Button appears but challenge data is empty

Cause: Script detected something that looks like a challenge but isn't

Solution:
1. Check console logs for what was extracted
2. Look for false positives (e.g., page text matching keywords)
3. Try refreshing the page and asking for a new challenge

Issue 4: No logs appear in console

Cause: Script not loading or being blocked

Solution:
1. Hard refresh page (Ctrl+Shift+R or Cmd+Shift+R)
2. Check Network tab for `/email-challenge.js` - should load successfully
3. Check for any script errors in console

Enhanced Logging

To get more detailed logs, you can run this in the browser console:

```
// Enable verbose logging
localStorage.setItem('foto_email_debug', 'true');

// Then refresh the page
location.reload();
```

This will show additional debug information in the console.

Quick Test Workflow

1. **Open chat page**: https://myfoto.topues.com/chat
2. **Open DevTools**: Press F12
3. **Go to Console tab**
4. **Ask chatbot**: "Give me a street photography challenge for Melbourne"
5. **Wait for response**
6. **Check console**: Should see `[Foto Email] Extracted challenge data`
7. **Click Email button**
8. **Check console**: Should see `[Foto Email] Sending challenge data`
9. **Check for errors**: If failure, note the error message
10. **Check Network tab**: Look at the actual API request/response

Expected Full Flow Logs

```
[Foto Email] Script loaded - Version: 2024112404
[Foto Email] Target email: seun_salami@outlook.com
[Foto Email] No chatbot iframe found
... (user asks for challenge) ...
[Foto Email] Challenge detected in page
[Foto Email] Extracted challenge data: {
  challengeText: "Urban Light & Shadow Hunt",
  category: "STREET",
  difficulty: "INTERMEDIATE",
  duration: "2 hours",
  location: "Melbourne CBD",
  recommendedGear: "Sony A7IV, Tamron 28-75mm",
  tips: "Focus on contrast between light and shadow...",
  weatherConditions: "Partly cloudy",
  detailedDescription: "Explore Melbourne's laneways..."
}
... (user clicks button) ...
[Foto Email] Sending challenge data: { ... }
[Foto Email] ✅ Challenge emailed successfully
```

What to Share for Further Debug

If the issue persists, please share:

1. **Console logs** (everything starting with `[Foto Email]`)
2. **Network tab screenshot** of the `/api/challenges/email` request
3. **Request payload** from the Network tab
4. **Response body** from the Network tab
5. **What the chatbot returned** (the actual challenge text)

This will help identify exactly where the failure is occurring.

Last Updated: November 25, 2025
Script Version: 2024112404
App URL: https://myfoto.topues.com